

wildtag.ai - Volunteer Instructions

Thank you for helping validate camera trap images. This walks you through everything, step by step. It takes a few minutes to get started, and you need no technical experience or software installed beforehand.

SPECIES VALIDATION · CSS6@ST-ANDREWS.AC.UK

What's in your file

When you unzip the file you were sent, you will see:

- `Run wildtag.bat` - double-click this one to start (see below).
- `wildtag.py` - the app itself. You do not need to open this directly.
- `validate_env` - a private, self-contained copy of everything wildtag needs. You do not need to install Python or anything else.
- A folder named after the species you are validating, containing the images.

You do not need internet access, administrator rights, or any software installed. Everything needed is already in the folder.

Step 1 - Unzip the file

- 1 Right-click the zip file you were sent.

- 2 Choose "Extract All..." and pick a location, for example your Desktop.
- 3 Open the resulting folder.

Step 2 - Start wildtag

- 1 Double-click `Run wildtag.bat`.
- 2 A black window will briefly appear. This is normal - leave it be.
- 3 A few seconds later, the wildtag window will open.

Windows may show a blue "Windows protected your PC" warning the first time, because this app is not digitally signed. Click "More info", then "Run anyway". This is expected and safe - it happens because the app is new, not because anything is wrong.

Step 3 - Validate the images

- 1 Click the **Validate** tab on the left.
- 2 Click **Browse** next to "Validation folder" and select the species folder inside your unzipped folder.
- 3 A gallery of images appears, each already labelled with the species wildtag detected, with a confidence score below it.
- 4 For each image: if the label looks correct, do nothing and move on. If it looks wrong, click the image and choose the correct species from the list, then apply the correction.

- 5 If the correct species is not in the list, use the **"Not listed? Add a label"** box to add it. Your new label is then available for the rest of your images.
- 6 If you genuinely cannot identify the animal, choose **"unidentifiable"** from the top of the list rather than guessing.
- 7 When you have been through a batch, click **Mark batch complete** and confirm. Repeat until every batch is done, then close wildtag.

To correct several images that share the same error at once, hold **ctrl** and click each one (selected tiles turn blue), then click any selected tile to correct them all together.

Any other detections in the same photo are shown as a thinner amber box. You do not need to do anything with those - they are just there for context.

Step 4 - Send your results back

Either of these works, whichever is easier for you:

- A **Send the whole folder**
Right-click the species-named folder, choose "Send to" then "Compressed (zipped) folder", and send the resulting zip to the project lead.
- B **Send just your results file**
Open the species folder and return the single file whose name ends in `_validation.csv` (for example `fox_001_validation.csv`). This is much smaller to send. You may rename it if you like - the name does not matter.

Please do not open the `..._validation.csv` file in Excel or any other program before returning it, as that can quietly corrupt it.

A few important notes

- You only need to flag images where the label is wrong. Correct ones need no action.
- If you genuinely cannot identify what is in an image, choose "unidentifiable" rather than guessing.
- Please do not rename, move, or delete any image files.
- Images containing people are automatically blurred for privacy.
- Take your time - accuracy matters more than speed.

Thank you again for your help with this project.

Questions? Contact **`css6@st-andrews.ac.uk`**